

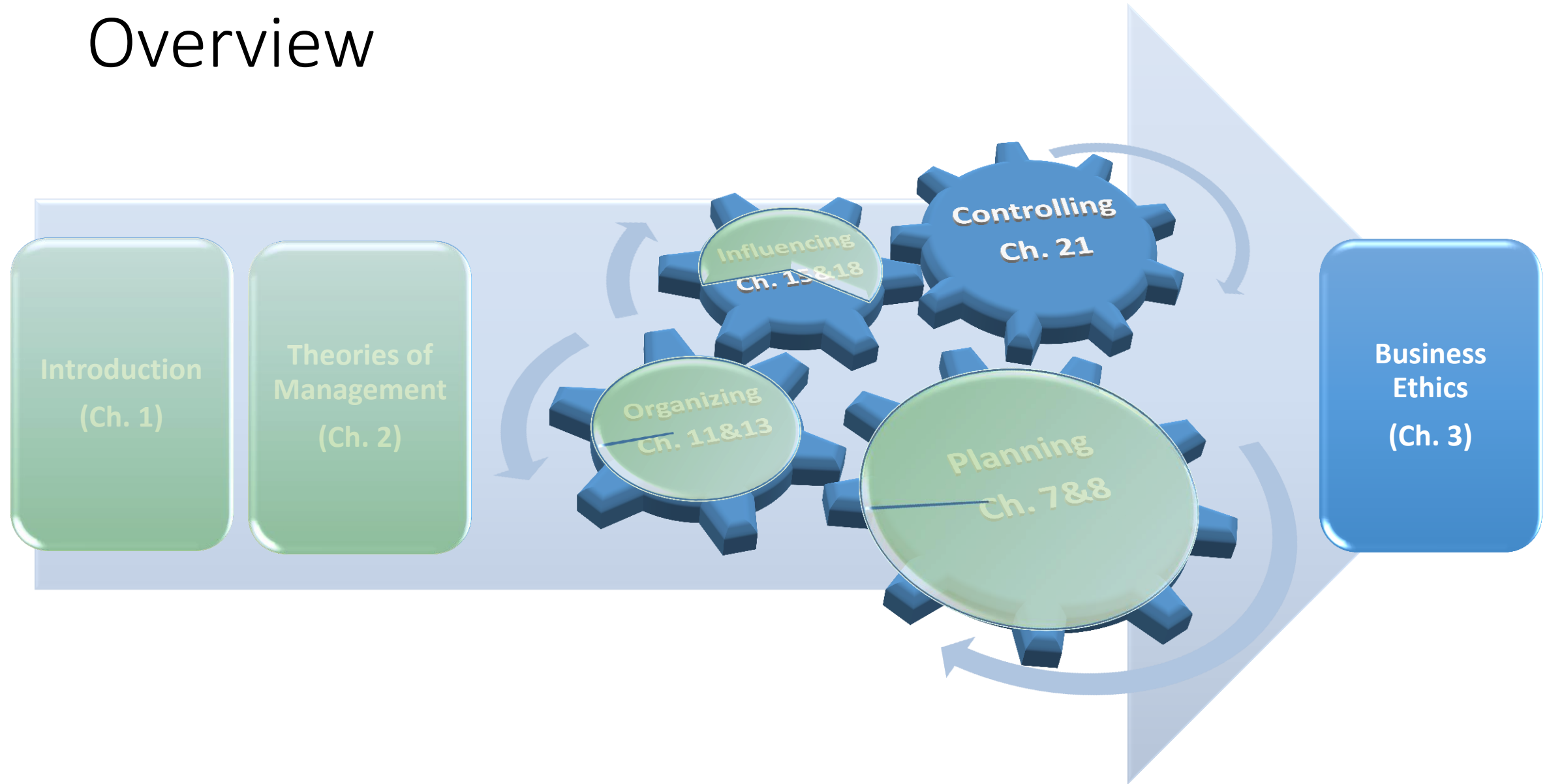
Chapter 18

Groups and Teams

By

Dr. Doaa Saleh

Overview



Objectives

1. *A definition of the term group as used in the context of management*
2. *A thorough understanding of the difference between formal and informal groups*
3. *Knowledge of the types of formal groups that exist in organizations*
4. *An understanding of how managers can determine which groups exist in an organization*
5. *An appreciation for what teams are and how they evolve*

Definitions

- **Group:**

~~Is simply a gathering of people.~~

It is any number of people who:

1. Interact with one another.
2. Are psychologically aware of one another.
3. Perceive themselves to be a group.

Why managers should study groups?

1. Groups exist in all kinds of organizations.
2. Groups inevitably form in all facets of organizational existence.
3. Groups can cause either desirable or undesirable consequences within the organization.
4. An understanding of groups can help managers raise the probability that the groups with which they work will cause desirable consequences within the organization.

Organizations Groups Kinds

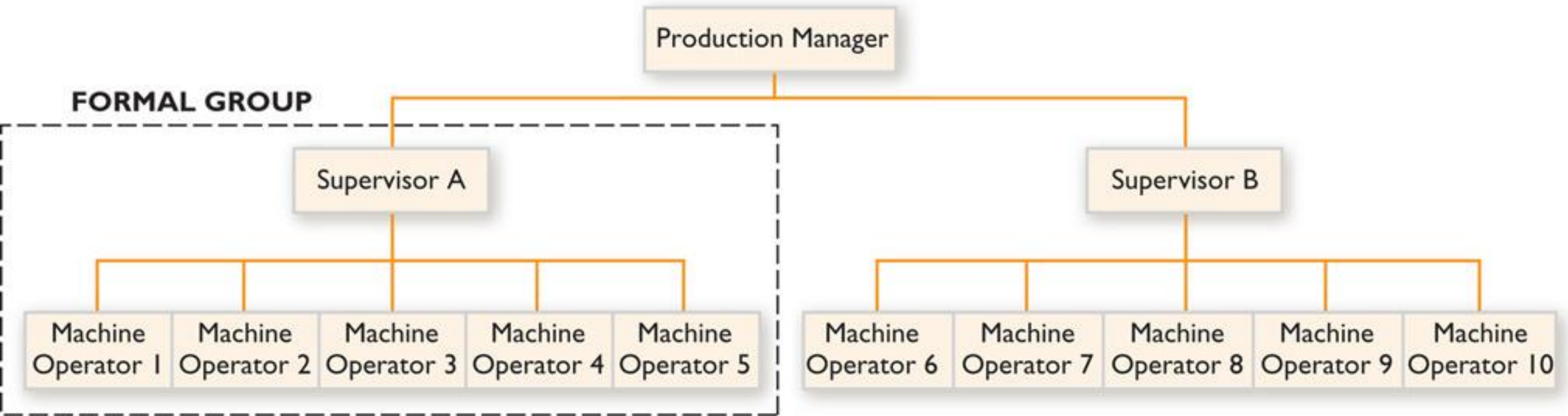
- **Formal Groups:**

Is a group that exists within an organization by virtue of management decree to perform tasks that enhance the attainment of organizational objectives.

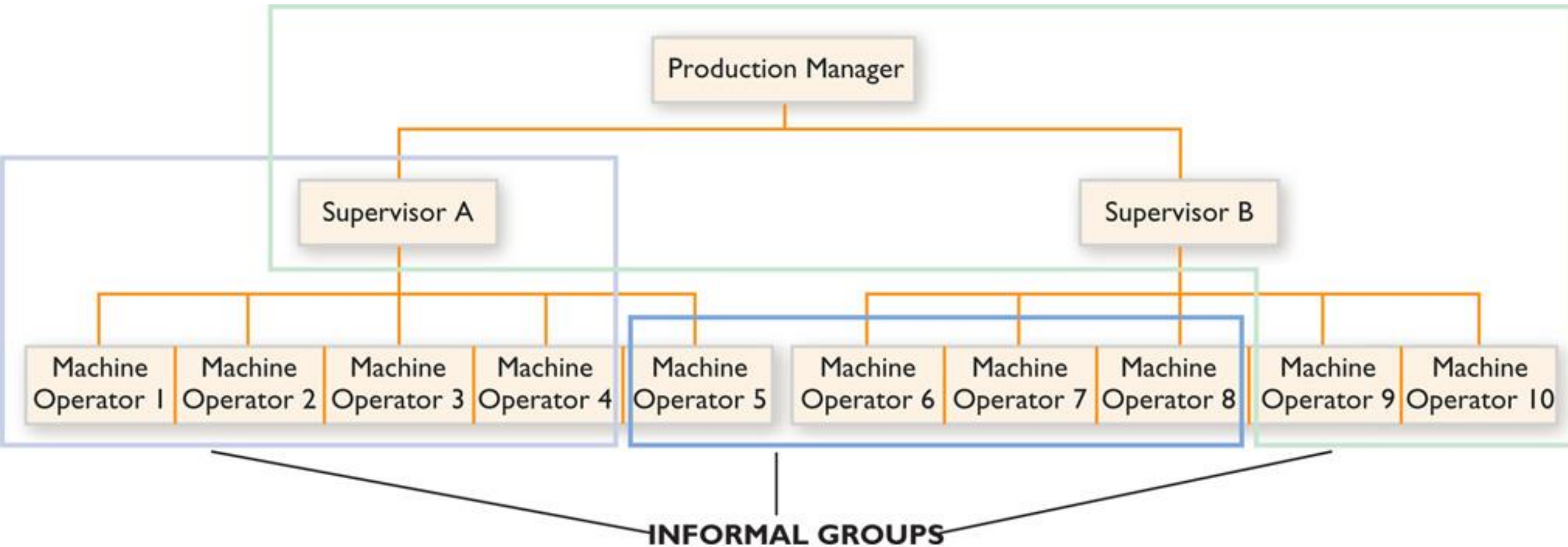
- **Informal Groups:**

Is a collection of individuals whose common work experiences result in the development of a system of interpersonal relations that extend beyond those established by management.

Formal Groups



Informal Groups



Formal Groups Kinds

- **Command Group:**

Is a formal group that is outlined in the chain of command on an organization chart.

- **Task Group:**

Is a formal group of organization members who interact with one another to accomplish most of the organization's nonroutine tasks.

Committees

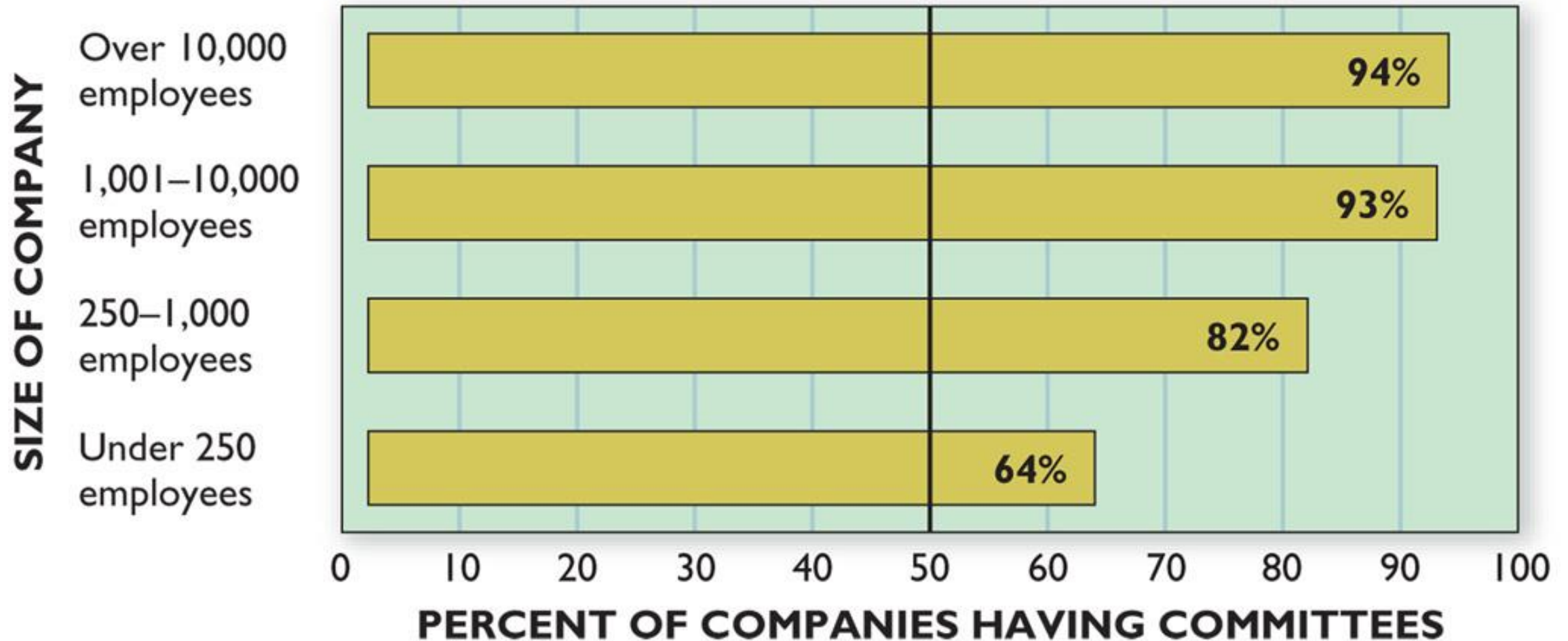
- **Committee:**

Is a group of individuals charged with performing some type of specific activity and is usually classified as a task group.

- Committees are established for four major reasons:

1. To allow organization members to exchange ideas.
2. To generate suggestions and recommendations that can be offered to other organizational units.
3. To develop new ideas for solving existing organizational problems.
4. To assist in the development of organizational policies.

Committees



Why Managers Should Use Committees

- Committees can improve the quality of decision making.
- Committees encourage the expression of honest opinions.
- Committees also tend to increase organization members' participation in decision making.
- Committees ensure the representation of important groups in the decision-making process.

What Makes Committees Successful?

- Procedural Steps.
- People-Oriented Guidelines.
- Avoid groupthink.

What Makes Committees Successful?

Procedural Steps.

- The committee's goals should be clearly defined, preferably in writing.
- The committee's authority should be specified.
- The optimum size of the committee should be determined.
- Select a chairperson on the basis of ability to run an efficient meeting.
- Appoint a permanent secretary.
- Distribute agenda and support material before meeting.
- Start meetings on time, and announce ending time at outset.

What Makes Committees Successful?

People-Oriented Guidelines.

- Rephrasing ideas already expressed.
- Bringing all members into active participation.
- Stimulating further thought by members.

What Makes Committees Successful?

Avoid Groupthink.

- **Groupthink:**

Is the mode of thinking that group members engage in when the desire for agreement so dominates the group that it overrides the need to realistically appraise alternative problem solutions.

1. A group member agrees with the entire group's position, even when the group member might privately oppose the entire group's position.
2. Group members feel pressure to conform and censor their own ideas.
3. Group members fail to make effective decisions.
4. Poor decision outcomes occurs when the group performs poorly.

What Makes Committees Successful?

Avoid Groupthink.

- **Groupthink Example:**

A board of directors of an international air freight service must decide whether the company should enter a cost-cutting war with their competitors. The board begins its decision-making meeting with the chairperson's loaded questions:

“Should we enter into this foolish price war or just keep rates the way they are?”

Definitions

- **Team:**

Is a group whose members influence one another toward the accomplishment of an organizational objective.

Are all groups in organizations are teams?



Are all teams in organizations are groups?

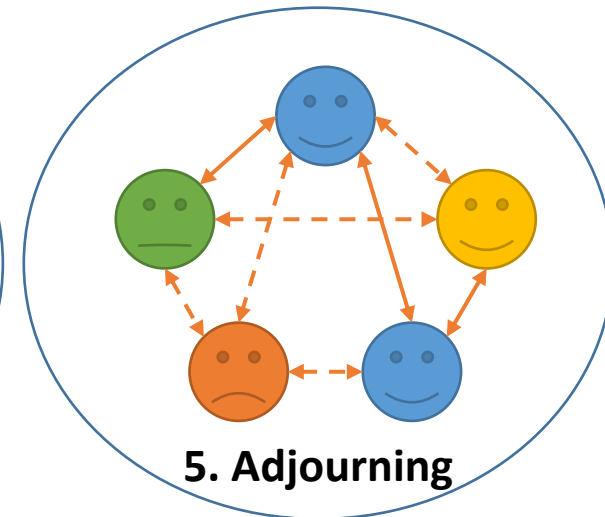
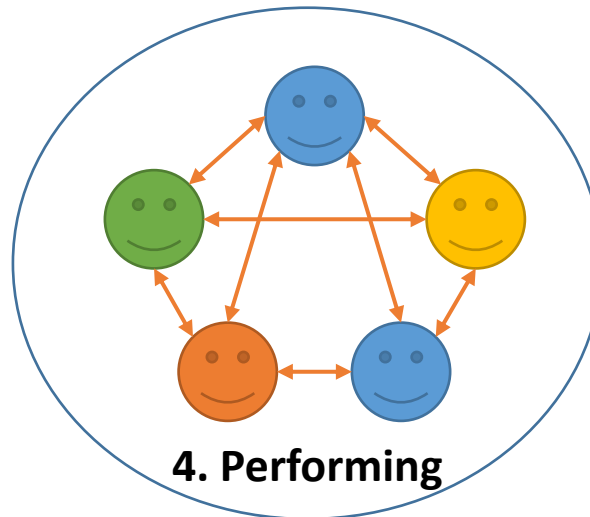
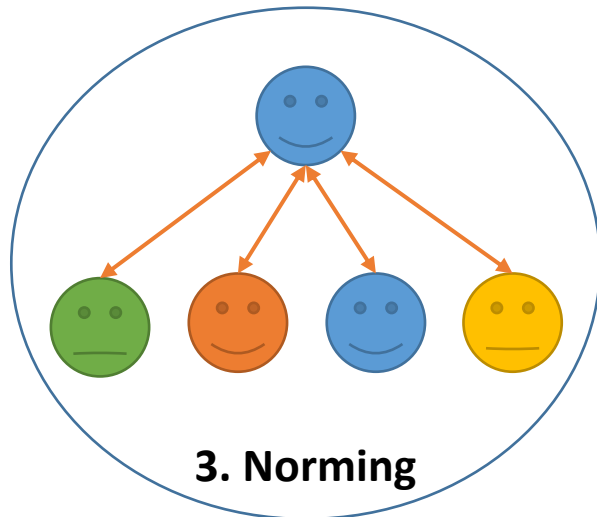
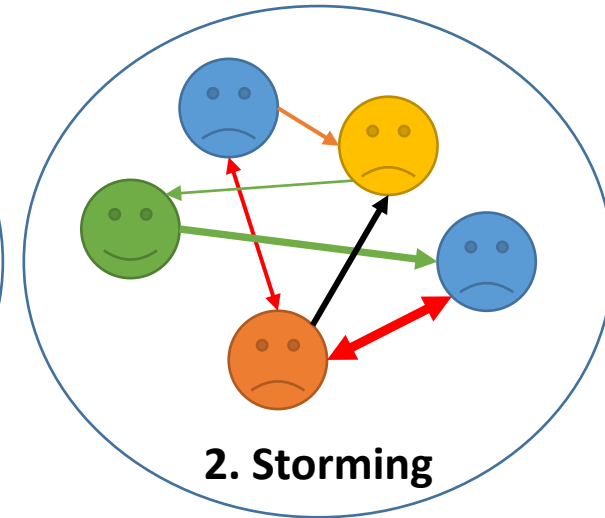
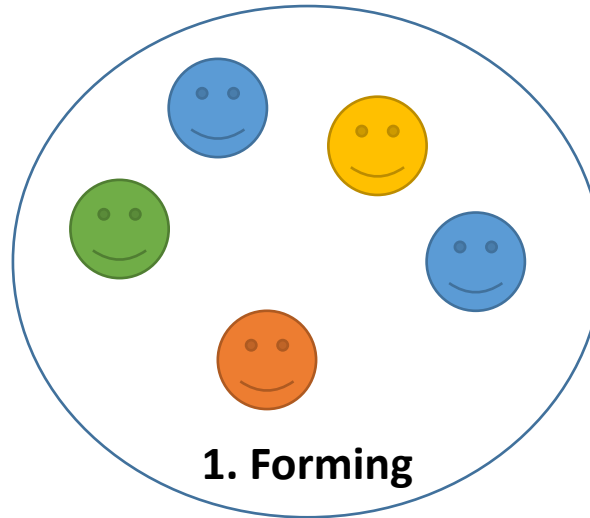
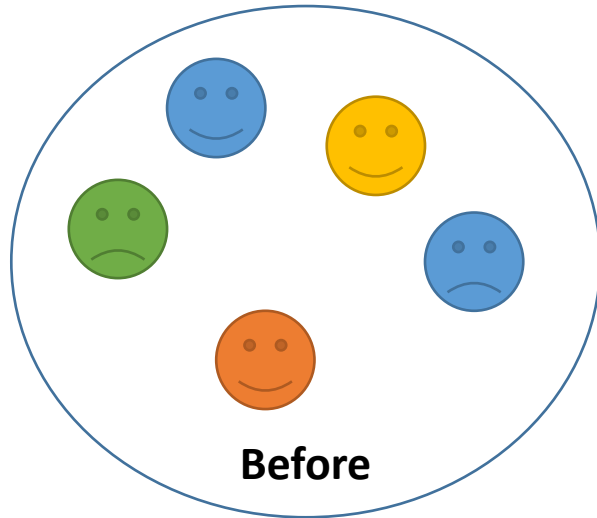


Good managers constantly try to help groups become teams.

Groups Vs Teams

	Groups	Teams
Goal	Share information.	Collective performance.
Synergy	Neutral.	Positive.
Skills	Random and varied	Complementary
Accountability	Individual	Individual and mutual
Roles and Responsibilities	Not always explicitly defined or developed	Clearly developed and discussed.
Rules and operating procedures	Not formally developed and evolve according the group's needs	Clearly discussed and developed to help team work together.
Methods	Group members interact, and work is usually divided.	Team members collaborate and coordinate efforts. Team members work together interdependently.

Team Development Stages



Informal Groups Kinds

- **Interest Group:**

Is an informal group that gains and maintains membership primarily because of a common concern members have about a specific issue.

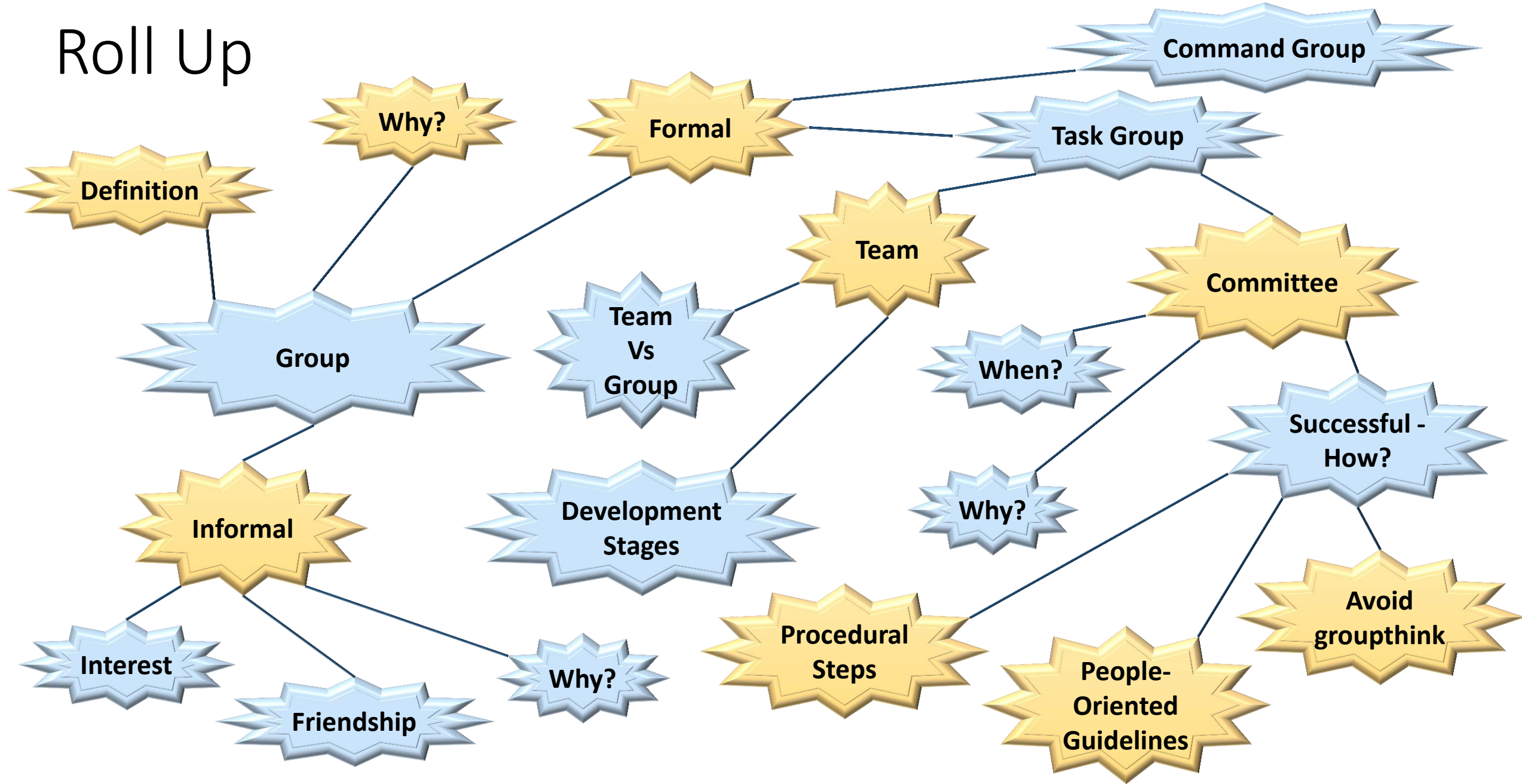
- **Friendship Group:**

Is an informal group that forms in organizations because of the personal affiliation members have with one another.

Benefits of Informal Group Membership

- Perpetuation of social and cultural values that group members consider important.
- Status and social satisfaction that people might not enjoy without group membership.
- Increased ease of communication among group members.
- Increased desirability of the overall work environment.

Roll Up



Overview

